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Client Operations Guide

How we onboard clients, what it costs, how we scale, and how to automate everything.

$6	48hrs	97%	3-5hrs
Your cost per client setup	Time to go live	Gross margin	Your work per client

💰 1. Startup Costs Per Client

Here's exactly what you spend to set up each client — and what you charge them.

Starter Client (You charge $500 setup + $300/mo)

Item	Your One-Time Cost	Your Monthly Cost	Notes
Twilio phone number	$1.15	$1.15/mo	Local number for their business
A2P 10DLC registration	$4.00	—	One-time SMS compliance fee
Render hosting (shared)	$0	$1.40/mo	Split across all clients
Claude API (their bot)	$0	$0.50/mo	Haiku model — nearly free
Your setup time	3-4 hrs	1 hr/mo	At $100/hr = $400 value
TOTAL YOUR COST	**~$5.15**	**~$3.05/mo**	
YOU CHARGE	**$500**	**$300/mo**	
YOUR PROFIT	**~$494**	**~$297/mo (99%)**	

Growth Client (You charge $1,000 setup + $500/mo)

Item	Your One-Time Cost	Your Monthly Cost	Notes
Twilio + SMS	$5.15	$8/mo	More messages, more channels
Facebook/Instagram setup	$0	$0	Free, just your time
WhatsApp messages	$0	$3/mo	Meta charges per conversation
Claude API	$0	$2/mo	More usage = slightly more cost

Your setup time	5-6 hrs	2 hrs/mo	More channels = more setup
TOTAL YOUR COST	**~$5.15**	**~$13/mo**	
YOU CHARGE	**$1,000**	**$500/mo**	
YOUR PROFIT	**~$994**	**~$487/mo (97%)**	

💡 **Key insight:** Your true cost per client is under $15/month. You charge $300-500/month. This is one of the highest-margin businesses possible. The main cost is your TIME, not the technology.

⏱️ 2. How Long Does Setup Take?

Day 0: Close Deal · Day 1: Onboarding Call · Day 1-2: Build Bot · Day 2: Client Tests · Day 2: Go Live 🚀

Phase	Your Time	What Happens
Onboarding call	30 min	Gather all business info, get account access
AI configuration	1-2 hrs	Train bot on their services, pricing, tone, FAQs
Channel setup	30-60 min	Connect phone number, website chat, social media
Testing	30 min	Test all conversation flows, fix any issues
Client review	30 min	Client tests it, approves or requests changes
Go live	15 min	Activate all channels, confirm everything works
TOTAL	**3-5 hours**	**Spread over 48 hours**

📋 3. What We Need From Each Client

Information (collected on 30-min onboarding call)

- ☐ Business name, tagline, and website
- ☐ Owner name and best contact number
- ☐ Service area and cities covered
- ☐ Business hours + emergency availability
- ☐ All services offered with price ranges
- ☐ Service call / diagnostic fee
- ☐ What they DON'T do (important!)

- ☐ Preferred communication tone (casual/professional)
- ☐ Any phrases or words they always use
- ☐ How to handle complaints or difficult customers

Account Access (temporary, for setup only)

- ☐ Facebook Page admin access (for Messenger)
- ☐ Instagram business account access (for DMs)
- ☐ Google account (for Calendar integration)
- ☐ Website login (to embed chat widget)

Assets

- ☐ Business logo (for chat widget)
- ☐ Any existing FAQ document or price list
- ☐ Business photos (optional)

> 📞 **Pro tip:** Do the onboarding call over Zoom and screen-share. Have the client walk you through their services while you take notes live. Most clients love talking about their business — let them talk, you capture.

🗂️ 4. Client File System

Each client gets their own folder. Organized, secure, easy to find anything.

```
ventures/clients/
├── CLIENT_001_suncoast_plumbing/
│   ├── INFO.md          ← Business info, contacts, services
│   ├── CREDENTIALS.md   ← All logins (NEVER on GitHub)
│   ├── CONFIG.md        ← Bot configuration settings
│   ├── NOTES.md         ← Meeting notes, change requests
│   └── ASSETS/          ← Logo, photos, documents
├── CLIENT_002_jones_electric/
└── CLIENT_003_pristine_cleaning/
```

What goes in CREDENTIALS.md (private file per client)

Item	What to store
Twilio	Their phone number, SID if separate account
Facebook	Page ID, access token, App ID
Instagram	Account username, business ID

WhatsApp	Phone number ID, token
Google	Calendar ID, service account
Website	Login URL, username, password
Payment	How they pay you (Stripe customer ID)

⚠️ **Security:** CREDENTIALS.md files are NEVER pushed to GitHub. Add to .gitignore. Consider using a password manager like Bitwarden for extra security.

🔑 5. Ownership — Who Owns What?

Recommended: Hybrid Model

Asset	Who Owns It	What Happens If They Leave
Phone number (SMS)	You (Twilio)	Transfer to them or they get new number
Facebook/Instagram page	Client (their Meta account)	They keep their page, you lose access
Bot logic & AI training	You (your IP)	You take it with you, redeploy for new client
Lead data captured	Client	Export their leads, give them a CSV
Website chat widget	You (your code)	Remove the script from their website

💡 **For client trust:** Be transparent — "You own your Facebook page and all your leads. If you ever leave, I give you all your data and remove my systems. No hard feelings." This builds massive trust and rarely leads to churn.

📈 6. How We Scale

Phase 1 — You do everything (0-10 clients)

Handle all onboarding, setup, and maintenance yourself. At 10 clients you're making $3,800/mo working ~20 hrs/mo. Highly sustainable.

Phase 2 — Systemize + VA (10-25 clients)

Create templates per industry. Setup time drops to 1-2 hrs/client. Hire a part-time VA ($15-20/hr) for onboarding calls and data entry. You still do technical setup.

Phase 3 — Hire technical help (25-50 clients)

> Hire 1 technical person to do setups. You focus 100% on sales. Revenue $15,000-19,000/mo. After paying help, you net $10,000+.

> **Phase 4 — Productize (50+ clients)**
> Build a self-serve client portal. Clients configure their own bot. Becomes a SaaS product. Unlimited scale potential.

Scaling Math

Clients	Your Time/mo	Monthly Revenue	Monthly Costs	Your Profit
5	10 hrs	$1,900	$130	**$1,770**
10	20 hrs	$3,800	$230	**$3,570**
20	35 hrs	$7,600	$420	**$7,180**
30	50 hrs	$11,400	$600	**$10,800**
40+	hire help	$15,000+	$2,000	**$13,000+**

🤖 7. How to Automate Everything

Already Automated ✅

- ☐ ✅ AI responds to every customer message 24/7
- ☐ ✅ Leads captured automatically in dashboard
- ☐ ✅ Discord alert when new lead comes in
- ☐ ✅ Appointment booking flow
- ☐ ✅ Bot stays awake via UptimeRobot

Automate Next (in priority order)

Automation	Tool	Benefit	Effort
Auto monthly invoicing	Stripe	Never chase payments	Low
Onboarding form → bot config	Google Forms + script	Save 1 hr setup per client	Medium
Monthly performance report to client	Scheduled email	Retain clients, show value	Medium
Auto review requests	Bot follow-up	More Google reviews for clients	Low
Bot health monitoring	UptimeRobot alerts	Know before clients complain	Low
Client portal (login + dashboard)	Custom build	Clients see their own data	High
Self-serve bot setup	Custom SaaS	Scale without your time	Very High

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📅 Client Lifecycle (Day by Day)

When	What Happens	Who Does It
Day 0	Sales call → Demo → Close deal → Take payment	You
Day 1	Onboarding call → Gather all info	You + Client
Day 1-2	Build + configure the bot	You (+ Finn)
Day 2	Send test link → Client reviews and approves	Client
Day 2	Go LIVE on all channels	You
Week 2	Check-in call — any tweaks needed?	You
Monthly	Auto-invoice sent → Client pays → Bot runs itself	Automated
Month 3	Upsell conversation — add more channels?	You

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